

Hypertension (High Blood Pressure) - Educational Overview

Educational summary aligned with common WHO hypertension public-health themes (educational use only).

Definition

Hypertension is sustained high blood pressure. It is often called a silent condition because many people feel well until complications appear. Long-term hypertension increases risk of heart attack, stroke, kidney disease, and other vascular problems.

Contributing factors

Contributors can include excess salt intake, unhealthy diet, physical inactivity, obesity, tobacco and heavy alcohol use, stress, aging, family history, kidney disease, and some medicines. Air pollution and other environmental factors are also discussed in public-health literature.

Measurement and goals

Blood pressure is typically recorded as systolic/diastolic values. Diagnosis and targets depend on clinical guidelines and personal risk (for example coexisting diabetes or kidney disease). Home monitoring can complement clinic readings when advised by a clinician.

Lifestyle and treatment themes

Common non-drug themes include reducing salt, eating more vegetables/fruits, maintaining activity, limiting alcohol, stopping tobacco, and managing weight. Medicines are often required and must be prescribed and adjusted by clinicians. Suddenly stopping medicines without advice can be unsafe.